

NM-2022-31: Repeat H2S excursion during TK-401 entry

Incident / Near-Miss Report: NM-2022-31 Category: near_miss_toxic_gas

Date: 2022-09-13 Area: Area 4 Equipment: TK-401

Title: Repeat H2S excursion during TK-401 entry

NARRATIVE:

Near-identical repeat of NM-2019-07. Entry crew withdrew when continuous monitor read 9 ppm H2S rising, ~35 minutes into sludge raking. Purge had again been curtailed (~3 h) because the eductor was borrowed by another job. Monsoon-season sludge load was high. Same failure pattern as 2019 despite SOP revision - procedural control alone is proving weak.

ROOT CAUSE: Purge below 4 h; equipment availability planning; monsoon sludge load.

PRECURSOR CONDITIONS: confined space entry; TK-401/Area 4; monsoon window high sludge load; purge duration below 4 h; eductor availability conflict

CORRECTIVE ACTIONS: Eductor dedicated to confined space jobs; permit checklist adds recorded purge start/finish times.

Associated permit: PTW-2022-0871

Reported to: M. Pillai (Safety Officer)